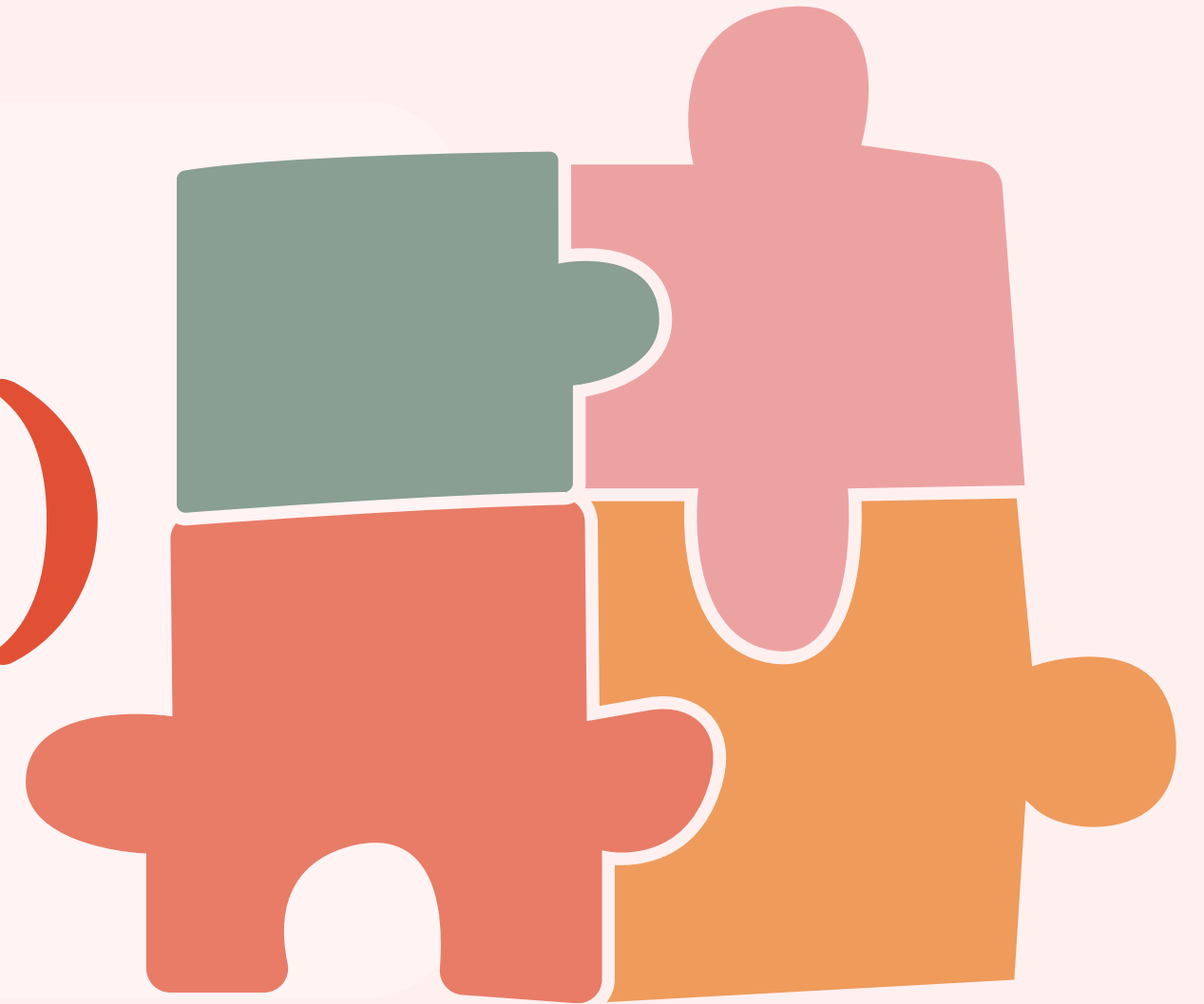


Wehmeyer & Kurth (p. 7-14)

Taylor Gravino



Overview

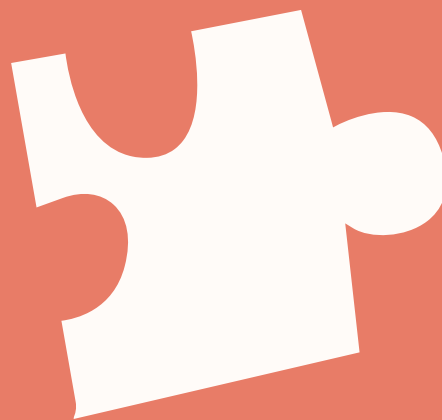


- Least Restrictive Environment
- Endrew F. versus Douglas County School District
- Takeaways



LRE, as outlined in IDEA, with clarity:

1. **Special Education** refers to **adaptations** to instruction, methodology, and content
2. **Supplementary aids and services** are distinct from these adaptations
3. **Federal law** prioritizes the **regular** education environment as the **default** context
4. **Special educators** should **provide** specially designed instruction **in regular settings**, *with removal considered only when students cannot succeed even with supports.*



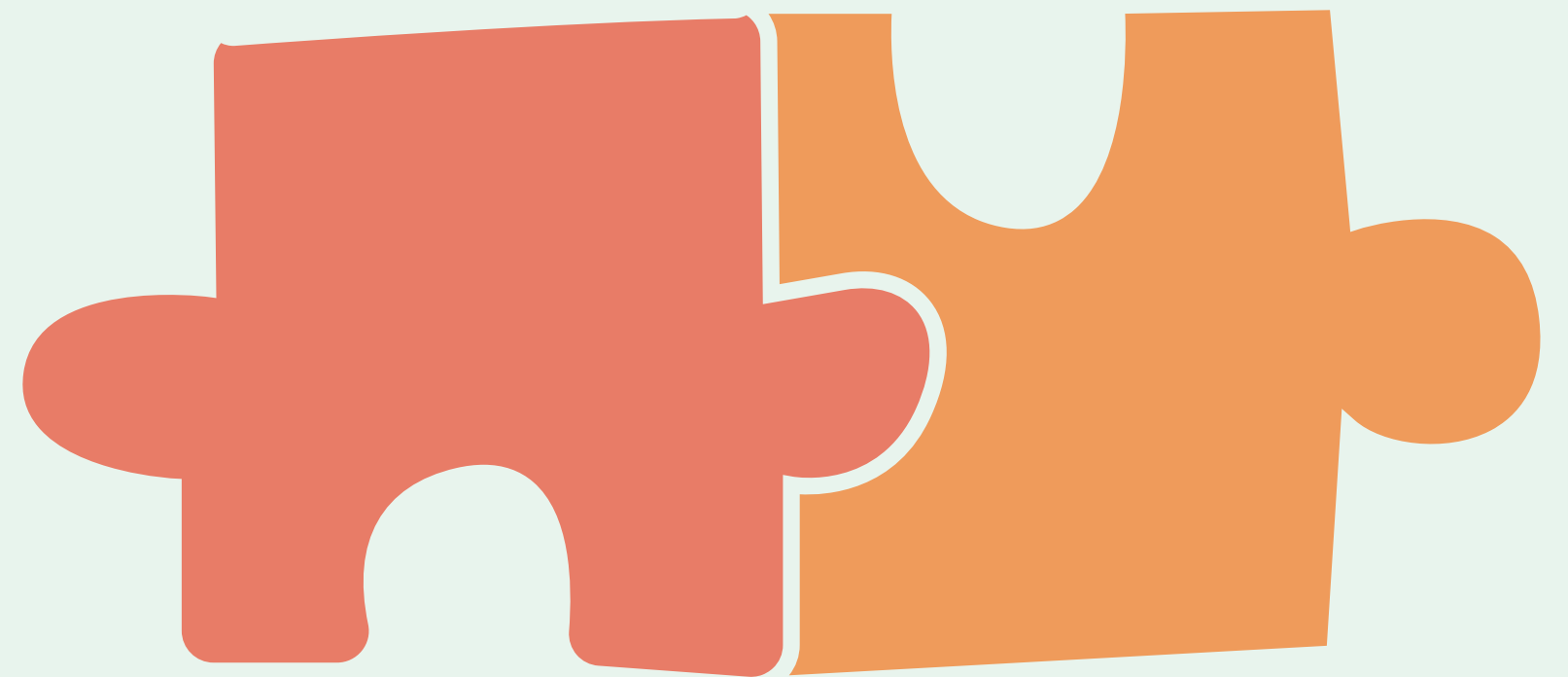
Andrew F. v. Douglas County School District

Ruling established:

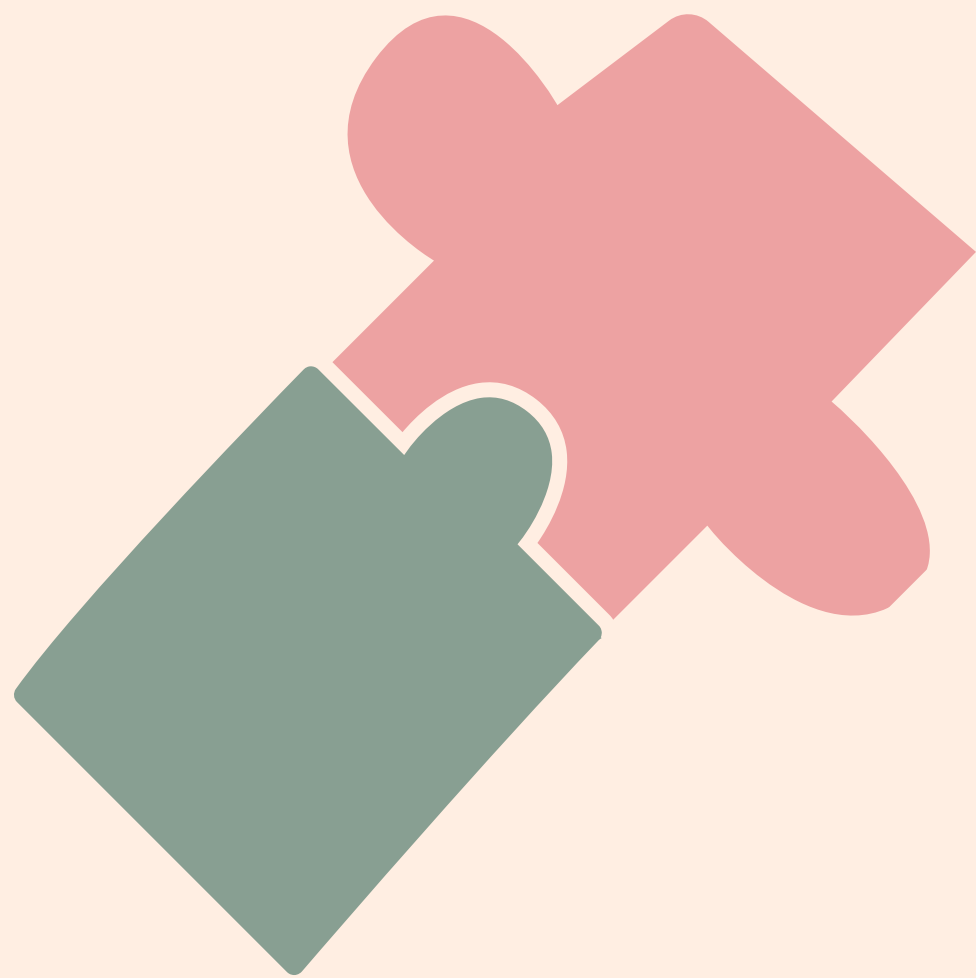
- A child's educational program must be **appropriately ambitious**
- Every child should have the chance to meet challenging objectives
- IEPs must consider the child's present achievement levels, disability, and potential for growth

Background

**Andrew F. was diagnosed
with autism at age 2.
He began schooling in a
district in Colorado.**



Parental Input



Situation: By 4th grade, his parents were frustrated with his lack of progress.

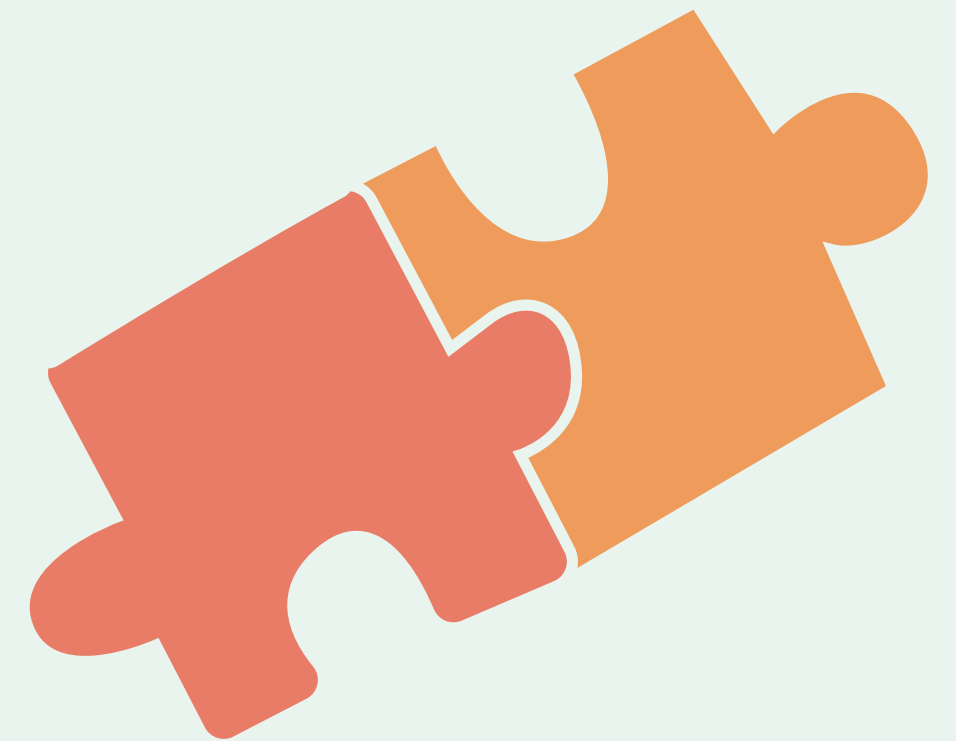
Behaviors: screaming in class, climbing over furniture, and elopement

Breaking point: IEP goals were repetitive and no meaningful progress being made

Progress at Private School

By 5th grade, Endrew's parents transitioned him to a private school for children with autism.

Growth: behavior intervention plan
& more challenging academic goals

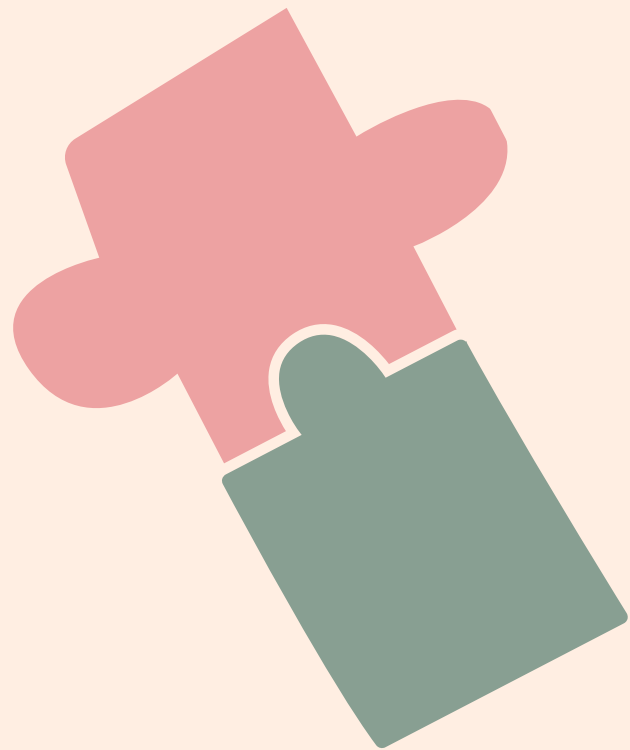


Legal Action

Parental Action: Parents shared information about Endrew's progress with public school district, hoping to reenroll with new plan

School Offer: presented IEP without change

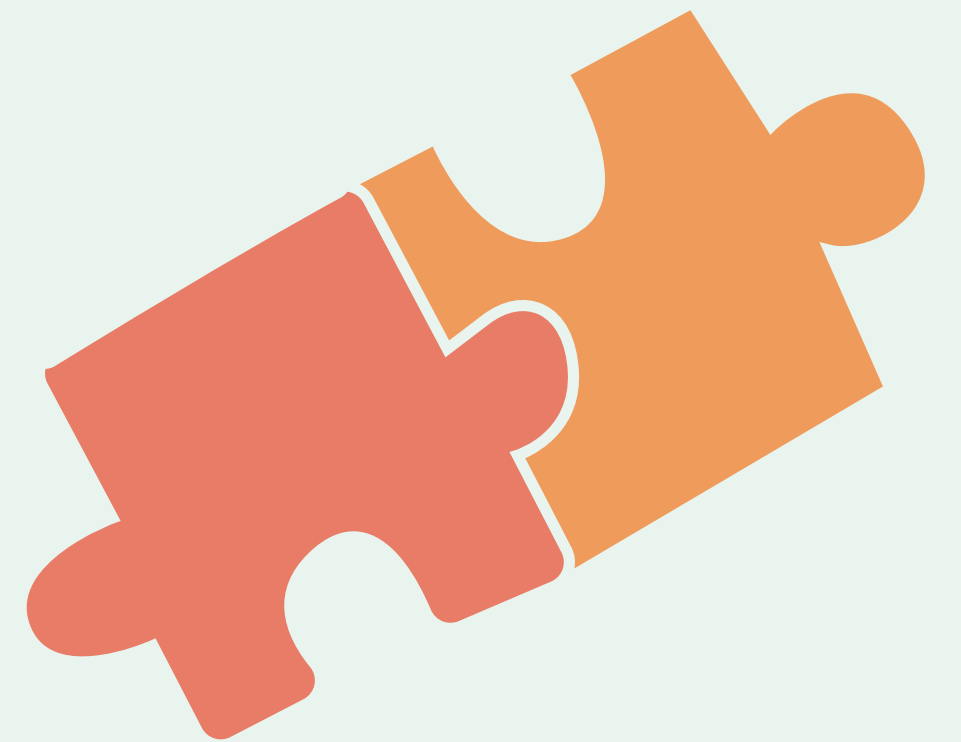
Complaint: Filed with Department of Education, seeking reimbursement for private school tuition



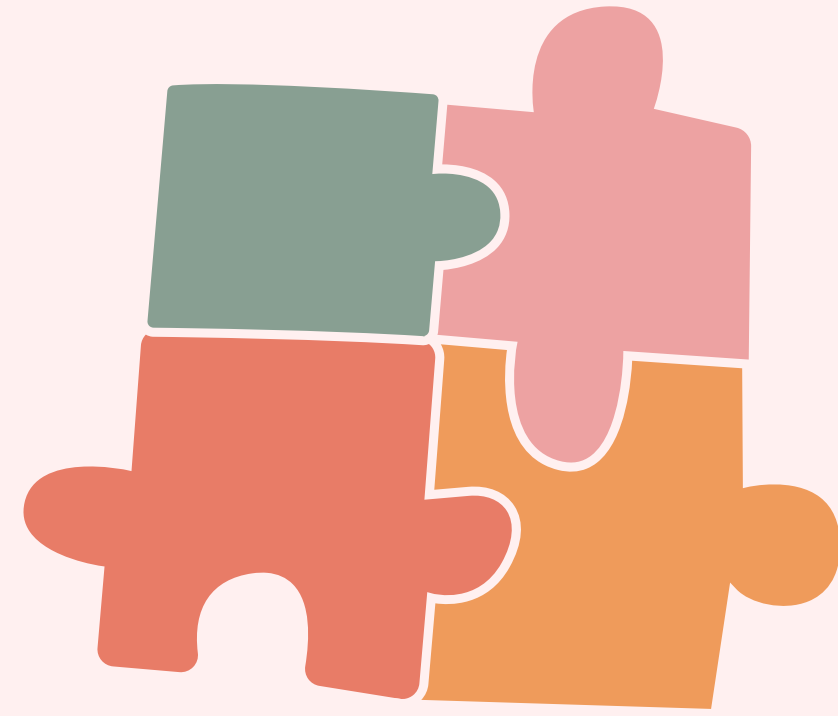
Result

Court determined that while Endrew did not show much educational growth and progress, the IEPs did show a pattern of minimal progress.

Supreme Court Ruling: “de minimis” standard, meaning merely more than minimal



Takeaways



1. “De minimis” fundamentally changed how appropriate or beneficial education is understood.
2. Rather than relying solely on present levels and disability, programs must consider the child’s potential for growth.
3. Strengths based approach is applicable to ALL students.

THANK YOU

